

OPS-004 | Carrier Delay Procedure

Verification, carrier contact, customer communication, and recovery handling.

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Training Notice

This is a fictional internal policy created solely for portfolio development, testing, retrieval, and RAG evaluation. It does not describe the policy of any real carrier, customer, or logistics company.

1. Purpose

Provide a repeatable response when a carrier reports a delay or shipment telemetry indicates that a carrier milestone is late, missed, or no longer credible.

2. Initial verification

Before contacting a carrier or customer, verify that the delay is based on trusted operational data. Do not treat an LLM summary as the source of truth.

- Confirm shipment identifier and current status.
- Check the committed ETA and latest trusted event timestamp.
- Identify the carrier and current route segment.
- Check whether the carrier has already provided a revised ETA.
- Review severe-weather guidance if weather may be a contributing factor.

3. Delay categories

Category	Definition	Target response
Minor	Milestone slip under 4 hours with a credible next scan or carrier confirmation.	Monitor; no customer notice by default.
Material	4-24 hour expected impact or a missed committed delivery window.	Carrier confirmation and customer-impact review.
Critical	More than 24 hours, repeated missed milestones, lost visibility, or HIGH risk.	Escalate to Operations Supervisor within 30 minutes.

4. Carrier contact procedure

When carrier contact is required, the operator or authorized automation must request specific facts rather than a generic status update.

- Current physical or network location of the shipment.
- Cause of delay, if known.
- Next expected milestone and revised ETA.
- Whether capacity, customs, weather, or operational restrictions are involved.
- Whether a recovery action is available and whether it changes cost or service commitment.

If no carrier response is received within 45 minutes for a HIGH-risk shipment, the case remains escalated and the Supervisor should evaluate an alternate recovery path.

5. Customer communication

Customer communication should be factual, concise, and based on confirmed information. Do not promise a new delivery time unless the revised ETA has been confirmed by a trusted source or approved by an authorized human.

Situation	Customer handling
No material impact	No proactive notice unless contract or customer preference requires it.
Committed window at risk	Prepare a customer notification with confirmed facts and the next review time.
Revised ETA confirmed	Communicate the revised ETA and any approved recovery plan.
Cause unknown	State that the shipment is under investigation; do not invent a cause.

6. Recovery options

Recovery options may include carrier trace, expedited transfer, alternate carrier, revised route, terminal pickup, or customer-approved delivery change. Options that alter cost, carrier, route, or service commitment require human approval.

Do not autonomously rebook, reroute, cancel, issue credits, or change a customer commitment based only on an LLM recommendation.

7. Closure criteria

- A credible next milestone is available and risk is below escalation threshold; or
- Delivery is completed; or
- A Supervisor approves a recovery plan and the shipment transitions to a separately managed exception workflow.

8. Example

A shipment is six hours late but the carrier confirms a terminal departure and a revised ETA within the customer window. This is a Material delay, not automatically a Critical delay. Document the confirmation, monitor the next milestone, and avoid unnecessary escalation unless risk indicators worsen.